

# GIOVANNI RIGHETTI

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## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Health Economics, Industrial Organization, Applied Microeconomics

## ACADEMIC POSITIONS

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**Postdoc – Nova School of Business and Economics** 2025–2026

- Social Equity Initiative, funded by “la Caixa”/BPI (supervision: Prof. Pedro Pita Barros)
- Hi-Prix Project “Health Innovation Next Generation Payment & Pricing Models” (supervision: Prof. Pedro Pita Barros)
  - Visiting at Imperial College London (supervision: Prof. Marisa Miraldo)

**Postdoc – University of Verona** 2024

Supervision: Prof. Paolo Pertile

## EDUCATION

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**Ph.D. in Economics & Management – University of Verona** 2019–2024

Thesis: “Cross-Country Interactions in Pharmaceutical Regulations”. Supervisor: Prof. P. Pertile. Jury members: Izabela Jelovac (GATE Lyon), Paola Bertoli (University of Verona), Federico Tamagni (Sant’Anna Pisa).

- Visiting at Toulouse School of Economics supervised by Prof. Pierre Dubois (Sept–Dec 2023)
- Visiting at Norwegian School of Economics supervised by Prof. Kurt Brekke (Jan–Jun 2023)

**M.Sc. in Economics – University of Verona** (110/110 cum Laude) 2017–2019

**B.Sc. in Economics and Accounting – University of Verona** 2014–2017

## JOB MARKET PAPER

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“Pricing Without Borders: Spillovers of External Reference Pricing in Pharmaceutical Regulation”  
with S. Gamba and P. Pertile

In response to rising drug spending, many countries use external reference pricing (ERP), which links domestic prices to foreign benchmarks. We show theoretically that strategic responses to the adoption of ERP by one country can create spillover effects with unintended consequences, including the possibility that the price reduction for the ERP adopter is less than expected. Exploiting the introduction of ERP in Germany in 2011 in a difference-in-differences design, we find that this policy caused a price increase in reference countries of 6.6% relative to non-reference markets. Results are robust across specifications, including an approach that accounts for confidential discounts.

## PUBLICATIONS

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- [1] Righetti G. (2026). *The Impact of Health Technology Assessment on Pharmaceutical Prices: Evidence from Germany*. *European Journal of Health Economics*
- Winner of the [AIES’s Young Researchers prize](#)

## WORKING PAPERS AND SUBMITTED WORKS

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- [1] Gamba S., Pertile P., and Righetti G. (2025). *Pricing Without Borders: Spillovers of External Reference Pricing in Pharmaceutical Regulation*. Available at SSRN: [dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5381635](https://ssrn.com/abstract=5381635). *R&R at RAND Journal of Economics*
- [2] Barros PP, Righetti G., and Sá L. (2026). *On the Long-Term Effect of Most Favored Nation Drug Pricing*. Available at SSRN: [dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.6373278](https://ssrn.com/abstract=6373278). *Under Review*

- [3] Barros PP, Righetti G., and Sá L. (2026). *Pricing Multi-Indication Drugs: Endogenous Patient Selection, Price Caps, and the Cost of Public Funds*. Available at SSRN: [dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5374679](https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5374679).

## POLICY OUTPUTS

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- [1] Barros, P.P., Righetti, G., and Sá, L. (2026). *Most Favored Nation Drug Pricing: Anchoring to a Moving Target*. **Health Affairs Forefront**, 6 May 2026.
- [2] Righetti, G. (2026). *Regulação Farmacêutica em Contexto Internacional: Implicações para o SNS*. Nova SBE, Social Equity Initiative – Health Economics Chair.
- Media coverage: *Correio da Manhã* (Portugal’s highest circulation daily), *Rádio Renascença*, and *Jornal Económico* (among others).
- [3] Righetti G. (2026). *O Puzzle dos Medicamentos Multi-Indicação: Como Definir o Preço de um Fármaco que Trata 42 Indicações?* **Marketing Farmacêutico**, 142, Jan–Feb, p. 20.

## WORK IN PROGRESS (SELECTED)

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- [1] “Escaping the ERP Trap: Confidential Discounts and Launch Delay under External Reference Pricing” with P. Pertile  
*Presented at SIEP, PET, EuHEA PhD, EHEW, and at the University of Verona’s internal seminar.*
- [2] “Mind the Gap: Toward an Equity-Conscious Pricing System for Multi-Indication Drugs” with P.P. Barros, B. Haon, L. Rochaix, and L. Sá  
*Presented at APES CNES, EHEW, and at the NHEM’s internal seminar.*
- [3] “The Clinical Trial Balloon: How Strategic Eligibility Design Inflates Measured Therapeutic Benefit of Cancer Drugs” with A. Gentilini, C. Santos, M. Miraldo, P.P. Barros and L. Sá  
*Presented at Hospinnomics internal seminar, 1<sup>st</sup> Iberian Early-Career Research Meeting in Health Economics, AEHESG, EuHEA 2026 Conference.*
- [4] “Losing Control: Patient Organizations and Retention in Randomized Clinical Trials”  
*Presented at the University of Verona’s internal seminar and at the NHEM internal seminar.*
- [5] “The Price of Choice: How Private Hospital Access Shapes Out-of-Pocket Spending” with P. Bertoli and C. Fertoni
- [6] “Does Early Entry with Dynamic Pricing Work?” with P.P. Barros and L. Sá.

## TEACHING

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*Catholic University of Milan*

2026 Microeconomics (BSc)

*University of Verona*

2025 Economics and Policy of Innovation (MSc)

2024 Economics and Policy of Innovation (MSc), Microeconomics (BSc)

2022 T.A. in Public Economics (BSc), T.A. in Probability (PhD)

2021 T.A. in Industrial Economics (BSc), T.A. in Public Economics (BSc)

2020 T.A. in Industrial Economics (BSc), T.A. in Public Economics (BSc)

2019 T.A. in Public Economics (BSc), T.A. in Macroeconomics (BSc)

2018 T.A. in Public Economics (BSc)

*Thesis Supervision (MSc, University of Verona)*

2026 2 graduated, 5 ongoing

2025 5 graduated

## AWARDS

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- 2026 MSCA Seal of Excellence awarded for applicants with 85% score or higher (91.2%)
- 2025 AIES's Young Researchers Prize for Best Paper
- 2020 Winner of “Concorso di Idee: Settore Pubblico Acceleratore di Sviluppo” by the economic portal [lavoce.info](http://lavoce.info). Proposal presented at the “Festival dell’Economia di Trento”

## INVITED TALKS

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- 2026 University of Insubria (invited guest lecture), University of Brescia (seminar, scheduled), University of Milano-Bicocca (seminar, scheduled)

## PRESENTATIONS AT WORKSHOPS, SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

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- 2026 Brown Bag Seminar (Verona), 1<sup>st</sup> Iberian Early-Career Research Meeting in Health Economics APES–AES (online), X American-European Health Economic Study Group (Berlin), 24<sup>th</sup> European Health Economics Workshop (Lyon), EuHEA 2026 Conference (Rotterdam)
- 2025 XXX Italian Health Economics Association (AIES) Annual Conference (Verona), 19<sup>th</sup> Portuguese Health Economic Conference (Porto), EuHEA Online Seminar, Nova SBE Health Economics & Management Meeting (Lisbon), Brown Bag Seminar (Verona), IX American-European Health Economic Study Group (Oxford), 1<sup>st</sup> European Public Health Economics Conference (Palermo)
- 2024 12<sup>th</sup> BEEN Meeting (Turin), Brown Bag Seminar (Verona), International Conference on Public Economic Theory (Lyon)
- 2023 TSE IO Workshop (Toulouse), 35<sup>th</sup> SIEP Conference (Verona), 10<sup>th</sup> EuHEA PhD Conference (Bologna), VII American-European Health Economic Study Group (Harvard), 1<sup>st</sup> CEPR Health Economics Conference (Toulouse), 7<sup>th</sup> BECCLE Conference (Bergen), 22<sup>nd</sup> European Health Economics Workshop (Augsburg), Health Economists’ Study Group (Manchester)
- 2022 63<sup>rd</sup> SIE Conference (Turin), 29<sup>th</sup> European Workshop of Econometrics and Health Economics (Fribourg), 9<sup>th</sup> EuHEA PhD Conference (Galway), Empirical Health Economic Workshop (JRC Ispra), 26<sup>th</sup> SMYE (Orléans)

## OTHER ACTIVITIES

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- Project Manager, FLASH – Flexible Approaches to Support Health through Financing (Horizon Europe, GA 101095424), University of Verona, 2026–2027
- Refereeing activity: *Health Economics*, *Studies in Microeconomics*, *Pharmacoeconomics*
- Co-Organizer: X Workshop on Health, Immigration and Wellbeing (2026); [Early Career Workshop in Economics \(ECWE\)](#) (2024, 2025); [Brown Bag Seminar Series](#) (2023, 2024); Nova SBE Health Economics and Management Meetings (2025)

## COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS AND SOFTWARE

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Stata, MATLAB, R, Mathematica, Maple,  $\LaTeX$ , Python

## REFERENCES

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### Paolo Pertile

Professor of Economics, PhD supervisor  
University of Verona  
[paolo.pertile@univr.it](mailto:paolo.pertile@univr.it)

### Simona Gamba

Associate Professor of Economics, co-author  
University of Milan  
[simona.gamba@unimi.it](mailto:simona.gamba@unimi.it)

### Pedro Pita Barros

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Nova School of Business and Economics  
[ppbarros@novasbe.pt](mailto:ppbarros@novasbe.pt)

### Marisa Miraldo

Professor of Economics, co-author  
Imperial College London  
[m.miraldo@imperial.ac.uk](mailto:m.miraldo@imperial.ac.uk)